henceforth only noncombat US naval vessels would be allowed porting privileges, while US combat aircraft could no longer land at Changi Air Base. Similarly, the US ally Thailand also chose its ASEAN neighbors. The military-backed junta that had ruled Thailand since its overthrow of yet another popularly elected government in 2022 announced it was suspending cooperation with the US military, while urging both Washington and Moscow to provide further development assistance to help "stabilize" the domestic economy so that parliamentary elections could be scheduled at the "earliest possible date." The Philippines, for its part, welcomed the economic and political aid provided by the revised alliance agreed to with Newsom, but Manila openly sided with ASEAN in proclaiming itself a neutral, having already lost the remainder of its Spratly Islands claims in the weeks after the war, when PLA units took over all contested territory in the chain.

The nonaligned bloc found two champions in India and Russia. Both New Delhi and Moscow took advantage of the trifurcation of East Asia to advance their interests. India became the diplomatic and economic champion of the nonaligned nations, enhancing ties and even proposing maritime partnerships that would see Indian naval vessels escort the merchant ships of Southeast Asian nations. For its part, Russia offered deep discounts on military hardware to all nations pledging to maintain a nonaligned status. Moscow quickly became the major arms dealer in the region and offered Russian armed forces personnel to train nations in their new purchases.

Other global powers, primarily the Europeans, quickly lost the appetite to play any significant role in the Indo-Pacific. Once Beijing announced on October 1 that it would ensure freedom of navigation for all merchant vessels through its "zone of control" in the South China Sea, the European Commission stated that it recognized China's control over the body of water, and would work with the PLAN to file shipping manifests and routes of transit. The British government, which had begun plans to build a new base in Singapore, following on then defense secretary Gavin Williamson's December 2018 announcement, canceled the project and announced that all future planned